

afterthought. You travel more, party more, go out to eat more. Home is simply a pleasant place to be part of the time.

It would be great to retire and still afford the big house in Newport Beach or the condo in Chicago's near-North Side. You'd like to have a pool, patio, barbecue, and tennis court. But most of us have to give up the mansion to retire.

The rule is short:

Move

MOVING

Around 1900 my grandfather came from Holland and wound up in Buffalo, New York. He worked as a railroad carpenter by day and took English lessons from the dishwasher at night. He enjoyed the work and managed to save some money. But he hated the cold in Buffalo. To hear Grandpa tell it, penguins near Buffalo can get frostbite if they don't scurry for cover during a cold snap.

One night the dishwasher told Grandpa about a place where it never got cold. Grandpa checked that he understood correctly. "Here in the U.S.?" he asked.

The dishwasher nodded. "Place called Los Angeles."

"You can get there by train?" Grandpa wanted to know.

"You can, but don't even *think* about doing it. With weather so good, the place is overcrowded. You'll never get a job."

That night Grandpa looked in the mirror and said to himself, "Grandpa, why in the hell are you living in Buffalo when you could be living someplace else?" (Grandpa wasn't a grandpa then, and he never swore, but you get the idea.)

He beat it to Los Angeles the next day. When he got there a man waiting on the station platform asked what kind of work he did. Grandpa showed the man his tools. The man pointed him to a small group of contractors looking for carpenters. Grandpa went over and was hired a few minutes later.